THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES
CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR
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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET A

Chapter 5: **New Beginnings: Cities and States** | Class 7 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** Harappan (Indus–Sarasvatī) civilisation	2nd millennium BCE decline
2	**(d)** rājā	clan territory
3	**(c)** Magadha	Bihar
4	**(c)** Ganga plains	fertile land, iron, trade
5	**(a)** gaṇas or sanghas	early republics
6	**(c)** taxes or revenue	to maintain army and order
7	**(a)** symbols punched on silver pieces	early coinage
8	**(a)** Vedic texts	four categories
9	**(d)** could change occupations in need	flexible
10	**(d)** Prayagraj	Vatsa capital

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	New phase of city growth in the 1st millennium BCE in the Ganga plains (2).	2
12	Disappearance of planning, administration and trade led to rural life (2).	2
13	Territories of clans led by a rājā where people had settled (2).	2
14	Larger states formed by merging janapadas (1); Magadha, Kosala (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	First used copper/bronze (1.5); second used iron and had republics and monasteries (1.5).	1½+1½
16	Clans settled with a rājā (1); trade networks grew (1); small states merged (1).	1+1+1
17	Fortified with ramparts and moats (1.5); narrow gateways controlled movement (1.5).	1½+1½
	OR: Discussed clan matters (1); advised rājā (1); could remove incompetent ruler (1).	1+1+1
18	Monarchies hereditary kings (1.5); gaṇas assembly chose rulers (1.5).	1½+1½
	OR: Assembly took decisions by discussion and vote (1.5); even chose the ruler (1.5).	1½+1½

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	(i) New cities after 1st millennium BCE (1). (ii) Archaeology and literature (2). (iii) Fertile land, iron, trade (2).	1+2+2
	OR: (i) Gandhāra; Anga (1). (ii) Magadha, Kosala, Vatsa, Avanti (1). (iii) Fertile land, iron (1). (iv) Ujjayinī—Ujjain (2).	1+1+1+2
20	(i) Clan territories merged (2). (ii) Assemblies and rājā (2). (iii) Fortified (1).	2+2+1
	OR: (i) Vajji (1). (ii) Gaṇa/republic (1). (iii) Magadha monarchy (1). (iv) One of the earliest republics (2).	1+1+1+2

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET B

Chapter 5: **New Beginnings: Cities and States** | Class 7 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** 1st millennium BCE in the Ganga plains	new cities
2	**(c)** mahājanapadas	8th–7th century BCE
3	**(a)** Rājagṛiha	later Pataliputra
4	**(d)** moat	ditch with water
5	**(b)** Vajji and Malla	assembly chose the ruler
6	**(b)** iron metallurgy	better tools and weapons
7	**(b)** growing trade	exchange
8	**(d)** trade, business and agriculture	wealth creation
9	**(a)** with the passage of time	caused inequalities
10	**(b)** Bhubaneswar	Odisha

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Fertile land, iron ore and trade (2).	2
12	Deep ditch with water around a fort (2).	2
13	Assemblies of the clan that advised the king (2).	2
14	Republics ruled by assemblies, e.g. Vajji (2).	2

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Better ploughs (1); stronger weapons (1); trade and cities grew (1).	1+1+1
16	Eased trade (1.5); issued by mahājanapadas, symbols (1.5).	1½+1½
17	Division of work (1.5); organised society (1.5).	1½+1½
	OR: Brahmins: knowledge and rituals (1); Kshatriyas: defence (1); Vaishyas, Shudras: trade, service (1).	1+1+1
18	People changed occupations in need (1.5); texts and inscriptions show this (1.5).	1½+1½
	OR: Hereditary restrictions over time (1.5); inequality and discrimination (1.5).	1½+1½

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	(i) Both explained (2). (ii) Advice, decisions (2). (iii) Taxes, army (1).	2+2+1
	OR: (i) Tools, weapons (2). (ii) Easy exchange (2). (iii) Bronze, barter-like (1).	2+2+1
20	(i) Flexibility (1). (ii) Four listed (1). (iii) Became rigid (1). (iv) Discrimination (2).	1+1+1+2
	OR: (i) Definitions (2). (ii) Stability; inequality (2). (iii) Equality (1).	2+2+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.